



Workforce Shaping & Classification

TOPIC LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Upon successful completion of this topic, the student will be able to:
- 1. Given descriptions, identify General Schedule (GS), Wage Grade (WG), Pay Bands and Senior Executive Service (SES) pay systems.
 - 2. Recognize other types of pay that apply to GS and WG pay systems.
 - 3. Identify the basic provisions of the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA).
 - 4. Identify the purpose of position descriptions and job descriptions.
 - 5. Identify different methods for filling civilian vacancies (management reassignment, merit competition, hiring from off the street, outsourcing, mandatory placement programs (stopper list))
 - 6. Recognize key characteristics of the different methods of filling civilian vacancies.
 - 7. Identify different methods for reducing civilian staffing (Reduction in Force (RIF), Separation Incentive Program (SIP), Voluntary Early Retirement Authority (VERA), and furlough).

STUDENT PREPARATION

- Student Support Material
- 1. None
- Primary References
- 1. <http://www.opm.gov>
- Additional References
- 1. None



Overview

- Civilian Pay Plans
- Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)
- Position Descriptions and Job Descriptions
- Filling Civilian Vacancies
- Reducing Civilian Staffing



Importance Of Classification

- Recruiting
 - Hire the right person for the position
- Performance Management
 - Develop appropriate performance standards and expectations
- Workforce Development
 - Provide meaningful developmental opportunities





Classification

- Process of assigning Federal jobs to a pay plan, series, grade/band, and title
 - Pay Plan
 - Broad sense of work being done
 - Determines pay system
 - Series – a.k.a. Occupational Code represents a specific occupation
 - Grade/Band – the level the person is working at determines rate of pay

Personnel System	Pay Plan	Series	Grade/Band	Title
DEMO	ND	0830	04	Engineer
General Schedule	GS	0802	11	Engineering Technician
ACQDEMO	NH	0801	04	Engineer

e.g., GS-830-11 Mechanical Engineer



Classification Responsibility

Supervisor will:

- Determine duties, responsibilities, supervisory oversight, etc. of position
- Use information to prepare position documentation that is an accurate description of job
- Review annually with employee to keep up-to-date



Human Resources will:

- Use provided documentation to make classification determination
- Office of Personnel Management (OPM) Position Classification Standards, OPM Job Grading Standards, and DEMO Manual





Civilian Pay Plans

- Most common types of pay plans:
 - WG – Wage Grade (Blue Collar)
 - GS – General Schedule (White Collar)
 - DEMO – Personnel Demonstration Project Science and Technology Reinvention Laboratory (STRL)
 - SSTM – Senior Scientist and Technical Manager
 - SES – Senior Executive Service



Pay – Wage Grade (WG)

- Set according to local rates
- Covers trades, crafts, and labor positions
- Grade structure - 15 grades (19 for supervisory)
 - WT Apprentice
 - WG 1 – 8 Helper, Laborer, Limited
 - WG 9 – 15 Journey level
 - WL 1 – 15 Leader (WG Scale + 10%)
 - WS 1 – 19 Foreman & General Foreman (WG + 20%)
 - WD/WN Production Facilitating (same as Foreman)
- Grade Steps
 - 5 steps in pay scale – normal progression through the 5 steps takes 7 years



2025 Federal Wage System Regular and Special Production Facilitating Wage Rate Schedules for the Los Angeles, California (LA) Wage Area

WG WL-WS Grade	WG - Rates					WL - Rates					WS - WD - WN Rates					WD-WN Pay Level
	1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5	
1	20.56	21.43	22.29	23.14	24.00	22.64	23.57	24.51	25.46	26.40	31.17	32.45	33.75	35.05	36.35	
2	21.60	22.49	23.39	24.29	25.19	23.75	24.74	25.73	26.72	27.71	32.19	33.53	34.86	36.20	37.54	
3	22.63	23.56	24.50	25.45	26.39	24.88	25.92	26.96	27.99	29.03	33.21	34.59	35.97	37.36	38.74	1
4	23.65	24.63	25.61	26.60	27.58	26.01	27.09	28.18	29.26	30.35	34.23	35.66	37.08	38.51	39.93	2
5	24.67	25.69	26.71	27.75	28.78	27.12	28.26	29.39	30.52	31.65	35.25	36.72	38.19	39.67	41.13	3
6	25.69	26.76	27.83	28.90	29.97	28.26	29.43	30.60	31.78	32.97	36.29	37.79	39.30	40.82	42.32	4
7	27.69	28.89	30.07	31.19	32.33	30.51	31.75	33.03	34.31	35.58	37.85	39.41	40.99	42.57	44.14	5 1
8	29.69	30.93	32.17	33.36	34.59	32.64	34.01	35.29	36.69	38.05	39.76	41.36	43.04	44.68	46.33	6 2
9	31.60	32.92	34.22	35.58	36.89	34.74	36.22	37.66	39.11	40.58	41.65	43.39	45.18	46.85	48.60	7 3
10	33.59	34.95	36.35	37.72	39.13	36.91	38.40	39.90	41.54	43.07	43.59	45.37	47.25	49.02	50.84	8 4
11	35.52	37.01	38.46	39.90	41.42	39.10	40.71	42.32	43.95	45.56	44.44	46.27	48.17	49.98	51.84	9 5
12	36.90	38.46	39.92	41.47	43.04	40.60	42.30	44.00	45.77	47.36	45.56	47.42	49.33	51.21	53.12	10 6
13	38.26	39.90	41.47	43.06	44.66	42.14	43.90	45.60	47.37	49.16	46.91	48.87	50.80	52.77	54.72	11 7
14	39.59	41.23	42.88	44.53	46.23	43.46	45.33	47.12	48.96	50.75	48.51	50.52	52.54	54.57	56.55	8
15	40.99	42.63	44.34	46.17	47.84	45.05	46.95	48.76	50.68	52.54	50.21	52.30	54.35	56.45	58.51	9
											WS-16	52.03	54.18	56.34	58.51	60.69
											WS-17	54.08	56.32	58.55	60.86	63.08
											WS-18	56.33	58.68	60.99	63.33	65.69
											WS-19	51.32	53.46	55.60	57.74	59.88

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Order Date: 3 September 2024
Effective Date: 17 November 2024
Supersedes Schedule Issued 28 December 2023



Pay – General Schedule (GS)

- **Nationwide** system covering professional, administrative, technical, and clerical
- Grade structure - 15 grades
 - 14-15 High grades
 - 5-13 Working-level, supervisors (two-grade intervals)
 - 1-8 Entry level for clerical positions (single-grade intervals)
- Grade steps
 - 10 steps in pay scale – normal progress takes 18 years to reach step 10



Salary Table Index 2025-GS

w/Locality Pay for Los Angeles-Long Beach

Effective January 2025

Grade	Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4	Step 5	Step 6	Step 7	Step 8	Step 9	Step 10
1	\$30,515	\$31,538	\$32,552	\$33,563	\$34,576	\$35,168	\$36,173	\$37,184	\$37,225	\$38,171
2	\$34,311	\$35,127	\$36,264	\$37,225	\$37,643	\$38,749	\$39,856	\$40,963	\$42,070	\$43,176
3	\$37,439	\$38,687	\$39,934	\$41,181	\$42,429	\$43,676	\$44,923	\$46,171	\$47,418	\$48,665
4	\$42,026	\$43,427	\$44,829	\$46,231	\$47,632	\$49,034	\$50,435	\$51,837	\$53,238	\$54,640
5	\$47,019	\$48,586	\$50,153	\$51,719	\$53,286	\$54,853	\$56,419	\$57,986	\$59,553	\$61,119
6	\$52,414	\$54,161	\$55,908	\$57,654	\$59,401	\$61,148	\$62,895	\$64,642	\$66,389	\$68,135
7	\$58,244	\$60,186	\$62,128	\$64,070	\$66,012	\$67,954	\$69,896	\$71,838	\$73,780	\$75,722
8	\$64,503	\$66,653	\$68,804	\$70,955	\$73,106	\$75,256	\$77,407	\$79,558	\$81,709	\$83,859
9	\$71,244	\$73,619	\$75,993	\$78,368	\$80,742	\$83,117	\$85,492	\$87,866	\$90,241	\$92,615
10	\$78,455	\$81,070	\$83,685	\$86,300	\$88,914	\$91,529	\$94,144	\$96,759	\$99,373	\$101,988
11	\$86,199	\$89,071	\$91,944	\$94,817	\$97,689	\$100,562	\$103,435	\$106,307	\$109,180	\$112,053
12	\$103,316	\$106,760	\$110,205	\$113,649	\$117,094	\$120,538	\$123,983	\$127,427	\$130,872	\$134,317
13	\$122,857	\$126,953	\$131,048	\$135,144	\$139,239	\$143,334	\$147,430	\$151,525	\$155,621	\$159,716
14	\$145,180	\$150,019	\$154,858	\$159,697	\$164,536	\$169,376	\$174,215	\$179,054	\$183,893	\$188,733
15	\$170,769	\$176,461	\$182,153	\$187,845	\$193,538	195200 *	195200 *	195200 *	195200 *	195200 *

* Rate limited to the rate for level IV of the Executive Schedule (5 U.S.C. 5304 (g)(1)).



Personnel Demonstration Project (DEMO)

- DoW laboratories designated as Science and Technology Reinvention Laboratories (STRL)
- Broad band classification system
- Performance management system
- Simplified staffing & examining system
- Flexible compensation system
- Simplified Reduction in Force (RIF) system



Navy Demo Pay Plans

DEMONSTRATION PROJECT	PAY PLAN	CAREER PATHS	DEMO PAY BAND LEVELS					
			GENERAL SCHEDULE GRADES					
			I	II	III	IV	V	VI
Naval Surface Warfare Center and Undersea Warfare Center	ND	Scientific and Engineering	1-4	5-8	9-11	12-13	14-15	>15
	NT	Administrative and Technical	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	13-14	14-15
	NG	General Support	1-4	5-6	7-8	9-10	11-12	
Naval Research Laboratory	NP	Science and Engineering Professional	1-4	5-10	11-13	14-15	>15	
	NR	Science and Engineering Technical	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12		
	NO	Administrative Specialist and Professional	1-4	5-10	11-12	13	14-15	
	NC	Administrative Support	1-4	5-7	8-10			
Naval Weapons And Aircraft Divisions	DP	Science and Engineering	1-4	5-9	9-11	12-13	14-15	
	DT	Science and Engineering Technician	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	12-13	
	DS	Technical Specialist	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	12-13	14-15
	DA	Business Professional / Program Mgmt	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	12-13	14-15
	DG	Administrative Support	1-3	4-5	5-6	6-7	8-9	10-11
	NM	Supervision and Management		6-8	9-12	13-14	14-15	>15
Naval Information Warfare Center	ND	Science and Engineering Professional	1-4	5-9	9-11	12-13	14-15	
	NR	Technician	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	13	
	NO	Administrative/Professional	1-4	5-8	9-10	11-12	13	14-15
	NG	General Support	1-4	5-6	7-8	9-10	11-12	
	NM	Supervision and Management		6-8	9-11	12-14	14-15	>15



NSWC Demo Project Salary Tables 2025

w/Locality Pay for Los Angeles-Long Beach

Business and Technical Management Professional (ND)

I	II	III	IV	V	VI
\$30,515- \$54,640 (GS 1-4)	\$47,019- \$83,859 (GS 5-8)	\$71,244- \$112,053 (GS 9-11)	\$103,316- \$159,716 (GS 12-13)	\$145,180- \$195,200* (GS 14-15)	\$196,385- \$207,500* (SSTM)

Technical Management Support (NT)

I	II	III	IV	V	VI
\$30,515- \$54,640 (GS 1-4)	\$47,019- \$83,859 (GS 5-8)	\$71,244- \$101,988 (GS 9-10)	\$86,199- \$134,317 (GS 11-12)	\$122,857- \$188,733 (GS 13-14)	\$145,180- \$195,200* (GS 14-15)

Administrative Support (NG)

I	II	III	IV	V
\$30,515- \$54,640 (GS 1-4)	\$47,019- \$68,135 (GS 5-6)	\$58,244- \$83,859 (GS 7-8)	\$71,244- \$101,988 (GS 9-10)	\$86,199- \$134,317 (GS 11-12)

SSTM – Senior
Scientific
Technical Manager

* Pay cap



Pay - SES

- Senior Executive Service
 - Positions that are classified above GS-15 of the General Schedule

Salary Table No. 2025-ES

Rates of basic pay for members of the Senior Executive Service (SES)
Effective January 2025

Structure of the SES Pay System	Minimum	Maximum
Agencies with a Certified SES Performance Appraisal System	\$150,160	\$225,700
Agencies without a Certified SES Performance Appraisal System	\$150,160	\$207,500

****SES receives no locality pay****



Overview

- Civilian Pay Plans
- Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)
- Position Descriptions and Job Descriptions
- Filling Civilian Vacancies
- Reducing Civilian Staffing



Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)

- Protective legislation covering
 - Minimum wage rates
 - Overtime pay
 - Prohibition on child labor
 - Equal pay regardless of gender



Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)

- Applies to all wage grade and most GS employees in non-supervisory, clerical, technical, lower-graded professional, and administrative positions (non-exempt)
- Covered employees (non-exempt) **receive overtime pay** when management requires or permits **work beyond the basic work week**
- Employees not covered under FLSA (Exempt, Administrative and Creative) are **not automatically entitled** to overtime pay
 - may be given compensatory time (comp time) off
 - may be given overtime pay (pay caps apply)
 - may be given credit hours



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Position Descriptions & Job Descriptions

- Position Descriptions (PD)
 - Statements of duties and responsibilities comprising the work assigned to civilian employees
 - Should be kept current - may be changed whenever work changes
 - Accurate PDs are required to properly classify and fill positions
- Job Descriptions (JD)
 - Similar to PD, but for Wage Grade employees
- General Level Descriptor (GLD) with an addendum
 - Statements of duties and responsibilities comprising the work assigned to civilian employees



Overview

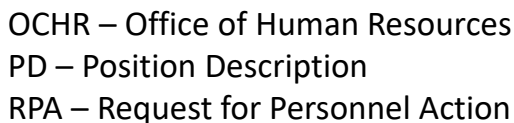
- Civilian Pay Plans
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Filling Civilian Vacancies

- Direct Hire Authority (DHA)
 - Temporary hiring authorities granted by Congress based on specific eligibility requirements
 - Veteran's preference does not apply
 - Job assessment not required; “by-name” requests are allowed
- Delegated Examining
 - Jobs open to any citizen
 - Veteran's preference given
 - May select any candidate in the highest rated category
- Merit Competition
 - Candidates evaluated against criteria
 - Selection process among best qualified
 - Competitive selection/promotion based on merit
 - Veteran's preference **does not** apply

Merit competition option is available for all civil service pay systems





Filling Civilian Vacancies

- Transition planning
 - Temporary promotion
 - Limited to 120 days
 - Detail (may be to a higher or lower-graded position)
 - Temporary reassignment
- Management reassignment
 - Organization does not have to advertise or compete the vacancy
 - Must clear the Priority Placement Program (“Stopper List”); priority for reassignment goes to employees in the area without a permanent position due to circumstances beyond their control
 - Same grade as vacancy
 - Must be qualified for the position
 - Employee does not have to agree with reassignment
- Outsourcing
 - Work that is not ‘inherently governmental’ may be contracted out
 - Rules for managing contract personnel are **not the same** as for civil service



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Reducing Civilian Staffing

- Reduction in Force (RIF)
 - Must get permission to conduct a RIF
- Separation Incentive Program (SIP)
 - No special pool of money for SIP
- Voluntary Early Retirement Authority (VERA)
 - No special pool of money for VERA
 - Like SIP, VERA paid for through vacancy
- Furlough
 - Only mission-critical designated employees work during a furlough
- Deferred Resignation Program (DRP)
 - Provides incentive for employees to resign or retire while receiving regular salary and benefits for a designated amount of time in a paid leave status
 - Generally, adopts the voluntary separation framework



Summary

- What are the civilian pay plans?
- What are position/job descriptions?



Summary

- What is the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA)?
- What are the methods used for reducing civilian staffing?



Summary

- What are the methods used for filling civilian vacancies?